



Even your own garden can be a good 'venue' for nature shots

Basic Techniques

The techniques you use depend on the situation, but generally include the following:

Manual focus is almost essential so you can position the plane of critical focus at just the right spot. In close-up photography about half of the available depth of field is in front of the place of critical focus and half behind it.

Exposure compensation with auto exposure bracketing (AEB): Not all cameras have this mode but it lets you capture a series of shots at slightly different exposures. You can often specify the difference in exposure ($1/3$, $1/2$, $2/3$ or 1 full stop) and the number of exposures in the series.

Sequential burst mode runs off the series of exposures as I hold down the shutter button.

Self-timer or manual shutter release: Which should be used depending on the situation again. If it is calm with no breeze at